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Secretary's File Room

Executive Order by the President.

PROVIDING FOR ORGANIZATION OF UNITED STATES FOOD ADMINISTRATION.

WHEREAS, Under and by virtue of an Act of Congress entitled "An Act to provide further for the national security and defense by encouraging the production, conserving the supply and controlling the distribution of food products and fuel" approved *10 August*, 1917, it was provided among other things as follows:

"That, by reason of the existence of a state of war, it is essential to the national security and defense, for the successful prosecution of the war, and for the support and maintenance of the Army and Navy, to assure an adequate supply and equitable distribution, and to facilitate the movement, of foods, feeds, fuel, including fuel oil and natural gas, fertilizer and fertilizer ingredients, tools, utensils, implements, machinery, and equipment required for the actual production of foods, feeds, and fuel, hereafter in this Act called necessaries; to prevent, locally or generally, scarcity, monopolization, hoarding, injurious speculation, manipulations, and private controls, affecting such supply, distribution, and movement; and to establish and maintain governmental control of such necessaries during the war. For such purposes the instrumentalities, means, methods, powers, authorities, duties, obligations, and prohibitions hereinafter set forth are created, established, conferred, and prescribed. The President is authorized to make such regulations and to issue such orders as are essential effectively to carry out the provisions of this Act."

and, WHEREAS, it is further provided in said Act as follows:

"That, in carrying out the purposes of this Act the President is authorized to enter into any voluntary arrangements or agreements, to create and use any agency or agencies, to accept the services of any person without compensation, to cooperate with any agency or person, * * * *"

NOW, THEREFORE, Under and by virtue of the power conferred upon me by the provisions of said Act and for the purpose of carrying the same into effect, I, Woodrow Wilson, President of the United States, hereby order and direct as follows:

There is hereby established a governmental organization to be known as and called

UNITED STATES FOOD ADMINISTRATION.

Said organization shall consist of an officer designated as UNITED STATES FOOD ADMINISTRATOR and such subordinate assistants and employees as may be selected by him for service in the City of Washington, D. C., and elsewhere, with the consent and approval of the President and under such rules and regulations as may from time to time be prescribed.

HERBERT HOOVER is hereby appointed UNITED STATES FOOD ADMINISTRATOR, such appointment to take effect from this date.

Said United States Food Administrator shall hold office during the pleasure of the President.

Said United States Food Administrator shall supervise, direct and carry into effect the provisions of said Act, and the powers and authority therein given to the President, so far as the same apply to foods, feeds and their derivative products and to any and all practices, procedure and regulations authorized or required under the provisions of said Act, including the issuance, regulation and revocation, in the name of said Food Administrator, of licenses under said Act; and in this behalf he shall do and perform such acts and things as may be authorized or required of him from time to time by direction of the President and under such rules and regulations as may be prescribed by the President from time to time.

He shall also have the authority to make use of the services of legal counsel and employ and fix the compensation of such counsel as may from time to time be deemed by him necessary for the purpose of aiding him in carrying this Act into effect.

And, WHEREAS, the President is further authorized in carrying out the purpose of said Act

> "to utilize any department or agency of the Government and to coordinate their activities so as to avoid preventable loss or duplication of effort or funds,"

all departments and established agencies of the Government are hereby directed to cooperate with the United States Food Administrator in the performance of his duties as hereinbefore set forth and to give said Administrator such support and assistance as may be requisite or expedient to enable him to perform his said duties and avoid duplication of effort and expenditure of funds.

In Witness Whereof, I have hereunto set my hand and caused the seal of the United States to be affixed.

DONE in the District of Columbia, this *tenth* day of *August*, in the year of Our Lord One Thousand Nine Hundred and Seventeen, and of the Independence of the United States of America, the One Hundred and Forty-second.

[SEAL.]

WOODROW WILSON

By the President:

ROBERT LANSING
Secretary of State.

[No. 2679–A.]

EXECUTIVE ORDER
Dated Aug. 10, 1917
Providing for organizing of U.S. Food Administration.